

Temple & Indo-Islamic Architecture

Nagara–Dravida–Vesara and Sultanate/Mughal features with dynasty pairs.

Portion focus ~36% · Topic: culture-arch

PYQ themes: Temple styles · Indo-Islamic features · Monuments

Why UPSC asks this

Feature!example!dynasty matching is the culture-architecture exam pattern.

Temple grammar

Plan, elevation, mandapa, garbhagriha. Regional schools (Odisha, Solanki, Chandela, Chola). Rock-cut to structural transition.

Indo-Islamic

Arcuate techniques, decorative calligraphy/geometry, garden tombs. Dynasty–monument pairs drilled weekly.

Map / list facts

- Khajuraho, Konark, Brihadeeswara, Shore Temple
- Qutb complex, Fatehpur Sikri, Taj

Must remember

- Nagara (north) shikhara; Dravida (south) vimana/gopuram; Vesara hybrid debates
- Arch, dome, minaret, jaali, char bagh